Asset Management and Hardware Lifecycle Policy

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Summary. Policy for managing Northstar Systems hardware assets from purchase to disposal, covering asset tags, inventory, 48-month laptop refresh, issue and return, loss and damage reporting, recovery from employees, secure disposal, write-off and capitalisation rules.

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1. Purpose and Scope

This policy governs how Northstar Systems Private Limited acquires, tags, issues, tracks, maintains, replaces, retires and disposes of hardware assets. It exists so that every device and valuable item is accounted for, protected while in use, and disposed of in a way that does not leak data or breach financial controls. It applies to all employees, contractors and managers who receive or manage company equipment in Bengaluru, Mumbai and remote locations, and to the IT Asset Manager, the IT Service Desk, Finance, Procurement and IT/Security staff who support them.

Covered assets include laptops, desktops, monitors, docking stations, mobile phones and tablets issued by the company, network and server equipment, security keys and tokens, printers and meeting-room equipment, and any other item that is tagged. Software licences are managed through NorthBuy contracts and are outside this policy except where a licence is tied to a specific device.

The policy should be read together with SEC-004 (device security and access), HR-006 (joiners, movers and leavers), OPS-001 (purchase approvals) and OPS-008 (budget and cost centres).

2. Definitions

- **Asset**: any physical item owned or leased by Northstar that is tracked in the asset register.
- **Asset tag**: the unique identifier in the form NS-AST- followed by 6 digits, for example NS-AST-004217, attached to every tracked asset.
- **Asset register**: the master list of all tagged assets, maintained by the IT Asset Manager, with owner, location, status, purchase date and cost centre.
- **Custodian**: the employee to whom an asset is assigned and who is responsible for its care.

- **Capital expenditure (capex)**: a single item costing more than INR 1,00,000 with a useful life of more than 1 year.
- **Refresh cycle**: the planned replacement interval for standard devices.
- **Write-off**: the accounting removal of an asset from the register when it has no remaining value or cannot be recovered.
- **E-waste vendor**: an authorised electronic waste recycler that provides a data-wipe certificate and a disposal certificate (illustrative; to be verified by Legal before external use).

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
IT Asset Manager	Owns the policy and register, assigns tags, runs audits, approves refresh exceptions
IT Service Desk	Issues and receives devices, logs incidents, coordinates repair and replacement
Custodian	Cares for the asset, reports problems, loss and damage, returns it on exit
Reporting manager	Approves requests for additional or upgraded equipment, confirms returns for movers and leavers
Finance Controller	Approves write-offs, oversees capitalisation and depreciation
Procurement Desk	Buys through NorthBuy under the Delegation of Authority
Security Desk	Handles lost or stolen device reports and remote wipe
People Team	Informs IT of joiners, movers and leavers through NorthPeople

4. Asset Lifecycle

An asset passes through six stages: request and purchase, tagging, issue, use and maintenance, replacement or return, and disposal. The asset register records each stage.

5. Purchase and Receipt

Hardware is purchased through NorthBuy with a purchase requisition raised against the correct cost-centre code. Approval follows the Delegation of Authority: up to INR 10,000 reporting manager, INR 10,001 to 50,000 department head, INR 50,001 to 2,00,000 Director and Finance Controller, INR 2,00,001 to 10,00,000 CFO, and above INR 10,00,000 CFO and CEO jointly. Quotation rules apply, and splitting a purchase to avoid a threshold is prohibited. Standard laptop models for each role family are bought in bulk by Procurement and approved yearly in the budget, so individual employees do not raise a requisition for a standard laptop.

On receipt, the IT Asset Manager checks the delivery against the PO and the delivery note, records serial numbers, applies the asset tag, and enters the asset into the register before it is stored or issued. An invoice is matched to the receipt before payment. A single item above INR 1,00,000 with a useful life over 1 year is recorded as capex and capitalised by Finance, and it is depreciated according to the accounting policy of the Finance team.

Example: Engineering buys 20 laptops at INR 95,000 each, a total of INR 19,00,000. Each laptop is below the INR 1,00,000 capex line as a single item, so each item is not capitalised individually under the capex test, but the total order is above INR 10,00,000 and therefore needs CFO and CEO joint approval under the Delegation of Authority.

6. Tagging and the Asset Register

Every asset must have a tag in the NS-AST- plus 6-digit format before it is issued. The tag is a physical label with a barcode, and for laptops, the tag number is also recorded in NorthGuard so that endpoint data can be tied to the register. Tags must not be removed or covered. A damaged tag is replaced by the IT Service Desk, and the replacement keeps the same number.

The register records the following for each asset: tag, description, serial number, model, purchase date, cost, cost centre, supplier, warranty end date, custodian, location, status and disposal date. The IT Asset Manager reconciles the register with NorthGuard reporting every month and with a physical check every 6 months. Differences are investigated within 10 business days. A full audit with Finance is done once a year before year end on 31 March.

7. Issuing Devices

7.1 Joiners

IT prepares a laptop for each new joiner before day 1 and issues it with a signed acknowledgement form recording the tag, serial number and condition. The laptop is enrolled in NorthGuard, encrypted and configured with the standard software image before issue. The employee signs in NorthDesk or on the form, accepting responsibility for the device.

7.2 Standard entitlement

Each employee receives one laptop for company work. Company laptops must be used for company work, and personal laptops are not allowed. A standard monitor, keyboard and mouse are issued on request for in-office and fully remote employees. Mobile phones are not issued as standard, except for roles that need them, which are approved by the department head. BYOD phones are allowed for email and NorthID only if enrolled in NorthGuard mobile.

Employees must not install unauthorised software, and standard users do not receive admin rights. Requests for additional hardware, such as a second monitor, go through NorthDesk and need the reporting manager's approval. High-spec devices need department head approval and budget availability.

7.3 Movers

When an employee moves to a different department, the cost centre of the laptop is updated in the register by IT within 2 business days of the move. Access changes follow the same 2 business day rule under SEC-004. The mover keeps the device unless the new role needs a different configuration.

8. Care and Acceptable Use

Custodians must keep devices physically secure, never leave them unattended in vehicles, public places or meeting rooms, and carry them in a bag. Full-disk encryption is mandatory and is reported by NorthGuard, and a device that is not reporting as encrypted may be blocked from corporate systems. Screens must lock after 5 minutes. Operating system patches must be applied within 14 days of release. USB mass storage is blocked by default, and exceptions are raised through NorthDesk with approval of the CISO delegate for a maximum of 30 days.

Company devices must not be lent to family or friends, must not be used for work outside India without HR and Security approval, and must not be taken abroad on personal travel without the

manager's knowledge. Working from a location other than the registered city for more than 10 working days in a year needs HR and Security approval, and this applies to the device as well as the employee.

9. Refresh and Replacement

9.1 Standard refresh cycle

Laptops are refreshed every 48 months. IT identifies the laptops due for refresh each quarter and informs the department heads. The refresh is planned in the annual budget under OPS-008, and devices that reach 48 months are replaced even if they still work, unless the IT Asset Manager approves a delay.

9.2 Early replacement

A device may be replaced before 48 months if it fails and cannot be repaired economically, if it no longer meets security requirements, or if the role changes and needs different specifications. The IT Service Desk must record a diagnosis from a technician. Early replacement because a device is slow or old is not approved without diagnosis, but the IT Asset Manager may approve it if performance prevents safe work.

9.3 Refresh exceptions

A department head may request a delay of refresh for a specific employee or team for up to 6 months, for example during a critical release. The request goes to the IT Asset Manager with a reason and is approved or refused within 3 business days. An exception does not alter security obligations, so the laptop must still be patched and encrypted.

Example: A support analyst in Mumbai has a laptop bought in July 2021. It reaches 48 months in July 2025, and IT includes it in the quarterly refresh list. The analyst asks to keep it until after a customer migration in September, and the department head requests a 2-month delay. The IT Asset Manager approves because the laptop is still patched and encrypted.

10. Loss, Theft and Damage

10.1 Reporting deadlines

Any loss or damage to a company device must be reported to the IT Service Desk within 24 hours of discovery. A lost or stolen device must also be reported to the Security Desk (ext. 5555 or security@northstar-systems.example) within 1 hour of discovery. The report states the tag, time, place and circumstances, whether the device was locked and whether Confidential or Restricted data may have been on it.

10.2 Response

When a device is confirmed as lost, the Security Desk locks the device and starts remote wipe within 4 hours of confirmed loss, disables access through NorthID and revokes tokens and keys stored on it. If the loss involved possible exposure of personal data, the Privacy Officer decides on notifications. For theft, the custodian must file a police report and give the copy to the IT Service Desk, and the custodian is informed of the steps through a Security Desk case.

10.3 Recovery from employees

Normal wear and accidents do not lead to recovery. Where loss or damage results from negligence, such as leaving a laptop in an unattended car or deliberately misusing it, the company may recover part or all of the cost from the employee. The IT Asset Manager reports the incident to HR, and HR reviews the facts, including the custodian's statement and the Security Desk's findings, before any recovery is decided. Recovery is made through NorthPay only after HR confirms, and the amount is based on the written-down value of the device. Late reporting beyond the deadlines is itself considered a breach and may lead to disciplinary action under the ladder of verbal warning, written warning, final written warning and termination.

Example: An engineer leaves a laptop on the back seat of a parked car and it is stolen. She reports it to the Security Desk within 40 minutes and to the IT Service Desk the same day. Remote wipe is completed within 4 hours. HR reviews and finds negligence, since the car was unattended in a public place, and decides on a partial recovery based on written-down value. Had she waited until the next morning to call the Security Desk, the delay would have been an extra breach.

10.4 Replacement

A replacement laptop is issued after the Security Desk and IT Service Desk close the incident review. In urgent cases, IT may issue a loaner device with a loan record for up to 10 business days.

11. Returns and Leavers

On exit, the employee must return all assets, including laptop, charger, badge, security keys and any other items before or on the last working day, and the device must be handed to the IT Service Desk. IT checks the contents against the register, inspects for damage and gives a clearance confirmation in NorthPeople. Access is disabled by 18:30 IST on the last working day. A leaver who does not return an asset may have its written-down value recovered from the full and final settlement after HR review, which must be completed within 45 days of the last working day.

Remote employees return devices via a tracked courier arranged by IT within 5 working days of the last working day, and the courier receipt must be shared with IT. Devices that are not received are treated as missing and escalated to HR and the Finance Controller.

12. Disposal and Write-Off

12.1 Data wipe and disposal

Devices that have reached end of life or are no longer needed must be disposed of only through a certified e-waste vendor. Storage media must be securely wiped before leaving Northstar control, and the vendor must provide a data-wipe certificate and a disposal certificate for each batch. IT keeps the certificates with the register record for at least 8 years in line with financial record retention. Devices must never be sold, given away or taken home by employees without approval of the IT Asset Manager and the Finance Controller, and any sale to employees must use the standard valuation approved by Finance.

12.2 Write-off

A write-off is needed when an asset is lost, stolen, irreparably damaged or disposed of with no value. The IT Asset Manager prepares a write-off note listing tags, reasons and net book value, and the write-off needs the approval of the Finance Controller. Finance updates the accounting records and the register is changed to disposed or written off. Write-offs of assets with a net book

value above INR 2,00,000 are also notified to the CFO.

12.3 Disposal records

Records of disposal must contain the date, tag, method, vendor name, certificate numbers and approvals. Records are kept for 8 years.

13. Audits and Reporting

The IT Asset Manager reports to the CFO and the CISO each quarter on the number of assets by status, assets not seen in NorthGuard for over 30 days, outstanding returns, losses, and devices beyond their refresh date. Audit findings are tracked, and high findings are remediated within 60 days. Repeated losses in a department are referred to the department head.

14. Exceptions and Escalation

Exceptions to this policy need written approval from the IT Asset Manager and, where security or financial controls are affected, the CISO delegate or Finance Controller. Disputes about recovery are escalated to the Chief People Officer. Employees who suspect a device has been compromised must contact the Security Desk immediately.

15. Related Documents

Device and access security is covered in SEC-004. Joiners, movers and leavers are in HR-006. Purchase approvals and quotation limits are in OPS-001. Budget planning and refresh funding are in OPS-008.

16. Revision History

Version	Date	Change
3.0	2024-12-10	Standardised 48-month laptop refresh
3.1	2025-06-21	Added e-waste certificate and recovery review rules